Chapter 8

Talking to the Server

Communicating with the server is an important task for client-side apps. The server is usually the source of data truth, and it has information the client needs. When server information changes, we may need to send updated data to draw a new part of the client application. The server also often needs to be informed of actions taken on the client in order to update shared information.

In a Hotwire environment, you can use Turbo Frames and Turbo Streams to manage a lot of server interactivity through regular HTTP requests to the server, which then returns regular HTML responses. However, sometimes you may want to manage server communication as part of your Stimulus and React code.

In this chapter, we'll look at using Stimulus to mediate a form submission in our sample application to perform searches. Then, we'll discuss what to do when you have to contact a server that returns data rather than HTML. We'll also look at how to get React components to receive API data and incorporate it into their state by sending and receiving data about which seats in the concert have already been held.